M. Erick Asella

An Ode to Curiosity



Curiosity

A pure drive has kept me going at the lowest point of my life.

While many people may have found their passion for cooking since childhood, whether through a grandmother's recipe, a mother's home cooking, or discovering great restaurants, my story as a cook did not start at a young age. In fact, I only learned how to turn on the stove at home quite recently, in 2022.

When COVID hit, many changes affected me and my family. It impacted my life in so many ways that I had to stop attending university and was left with no prospects for the future. I reached a state where my life felt as though it had absolutely no meaning. For a few years, it felt like I was trapped inside an abyss where no light could exist.

Then in 2022, while I was trying to lose weight and trying to make meals for myself, my mom showed me the way to the kitchen and guided me through my first steps in cooking. At that point, I felt like I had nothing to gain in life, but also nothing to lose. So, on the spur of the moment, I decided to try recreating recipes from my favorite restaurants, definitely something very different from my family's cooking.

I want to give my sincerest gratitude to Chef David Gee, Chef Rodolphe Onno, Chef Nidhipong Suriya, and all the instructors for sharing their knowledge with me as my teachers at Le Cordon Bleu Dusit. I also want to express my love and appreciation to the friends I met in class who have grown alongside me over the past year. May we all find joy on the road ahead in our culinary journeys.

Last but not least, big thanks to my brother from another mother **Abyan Ahmedizza Yusrin** for helping me design this book.



SALMON MOSAIC
WITH CUCUMBER GAZPACHO & SALAD

Mosaic serves as a symbol of broken pieces reassembled into a beautiful composition. The elegant salmon complemented with Cucumber Gazpacho and Salad served cold, gives this dish a fresh start to a culinary experience.

PART I

SALMON MOSAIC

INGREDIENTS

- 300 g salmon
- 30 g nori sheet
- 1 l water
- 40 g salt

METHOD

1. Remove skin and bones from salmon.
2. Cut salmon into long strips.
3. Boil water and salt, then chill. After, brine salmon for 15 minutes.
4. Bake half of the nori sheets 150°C for 3 minutes, then into powder.
5. Season salmon strips (pat-dried) with nori powder.
6. Wrap salmon tightly with nori sheets into a tube shape with cling film.
7. Vacuum seal, and cook sous vide 43°C for at least 30 minutes.
8. Chill in ice bath prior to serving (Served cold.)
9. Cut into desired thickness and serve.



PART II

CUCUMBER GAZPACHO

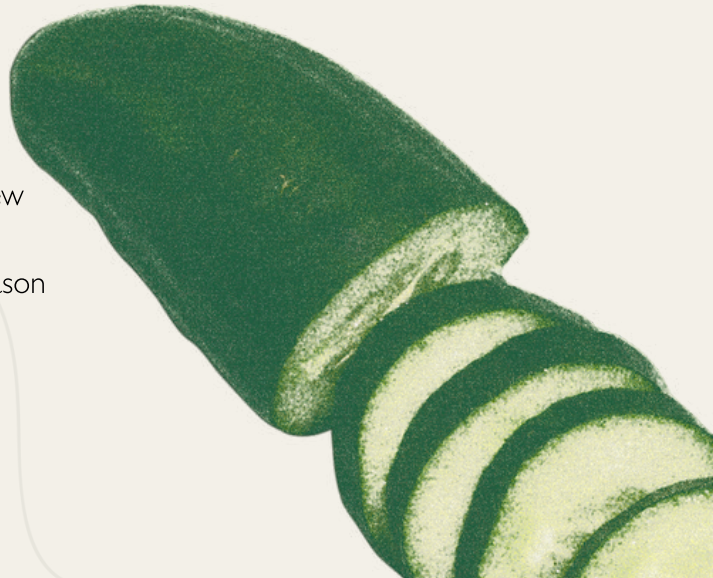
INGREDIENTS

- 2 cucumbers
- 50 g celery
- 200 g Greek yoghurt
- 30 g white wine vinegar
- 5 g parsley
- 5 g mint
- 5 g coriander
- 5 g chives
- 10 g garlic
- 1 lemon (juice)
- 150 g cashew



METHOD

1. Rough chop all vegetables.
2. Blend cucumber, celery, garlic, herbs, cashew until smooth.
3. Add yoghurt, vinegar, lemon juice, then season
4. Pass through muslin.
5. Chill.



PART III

SALAD GARNISH

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cucumber
- 20 g celery
- 20 g daikon



METHOD

1. Shave celery, daikon, and cucumber into thin slices with mandoline
2. Cut into desired shapes for garnishing.
3. Put to iced water to make them curly.
4. Drain and toss with dressing before plating.

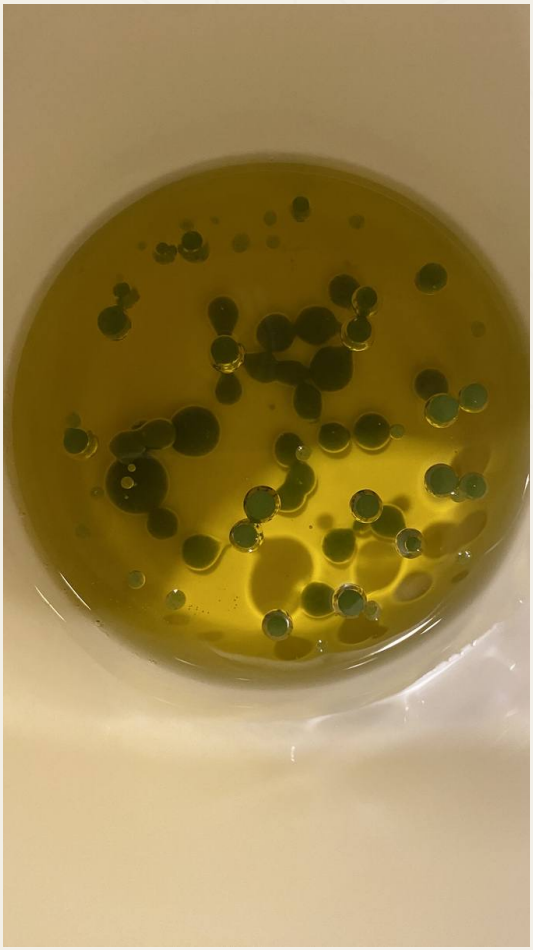


PART IV

CUCUMBER CAVIAR

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cucumber
- 1 g Agar
- 15 g Lemon juice



METHOD

1. Rough chop cucumber, then strain pulp and collect the cucumber juice.
2. Chill oil until cold, but don't freeze (need to be liquid).
3. Cook cucumber juice, season with salt and lemon juice, then activate agar-agar; bring it up to boil, then whisk all dissolves.
4. Bring the temperature down a little bit, then drip the mixture using the edge of a spoon to cold oil little by little.
5. Strain oil, then keep caviar in cold water.

PART V

DRESSING

INGREDIENTS

- 25 g white wine vinegar
- 75 g oil

METHOD

1. Whisk vinegar and oil to emulsify.
2. Season lightly.

PART VI

PARSLEY OIL

INGREDIENTS

- 25 g parsley
- 70 g Olive Oil





METHOD

1. Blanch and refresh parsley.
2. Blend with oil until smooth.
3. Strain through muslin.
4. Reserve for finishing.

PART VII

FINISHING & ASSEMBLY

INGREDIENTS

- Mint Leaves
- 10 g clarified butter
- Edible flowers

ASSEMBLY

- Salmon mosaic portioned, brushed with clarified butter, daikon discs, cucumber disc, cucumber caviar, cucumber ribbons, celery ribbons, mints, flowers
- Gazpacho, parsley oil







VEAL PROVENCALE

INFUSED JUS, POMMES SOUFFLEES, ROMESCO, & STUFFED MUSHROOMS

Provencale, a boon of curiosity through my love of food exploration. One of my favorite taste profile of french culinary. Veal tenderloin served with various ornaments flavored with provencale herbs repeatedly. A harmony of delicious components to satisfy your palate.

PART I

VEAL TENDERLOIN

INGREDIENTS

- 400 g Veal Tenderloin
- 1 g Thyme, Rosemary
- 20 g Butter
- 10 g Clarified Butter

METHOD

1. Trim tenderloin evenly, tie, season.
2. Dry, pan sear.
3. Baste with butter, rosemary, and thyme.
4. Finish in oven at 190°C, until it reaches 49°C core temperature.
5. Rest
6. Brush clarified butter powder, rub powder, carve, serve



PART II

PROVENCALE POWDER

INGREDIENTS

- 20 g bread crumbs toasted
- 5 g each of Basil, parsley, rosemary, tarragon, thyme, marjoram.
- 1 Pinch dried lavender



METHOD

1. Toast breadcrumbs until golden brown.
2. Chop herbs
3. Blend everything finely, then strain.

PART III

VEAL JUS





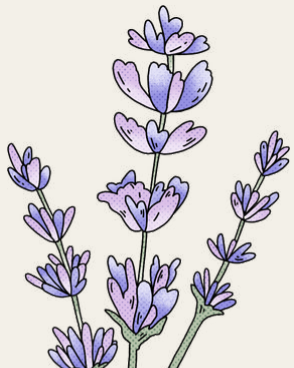


INGREDIENTS

- 200 g veal trimmings
- 30 g onion
- 30 g celery
- 30 g shallot
- 200 g veal stock
- 30 g butter
- 30 g white wine
- Lavender + basil
- 1 pc Bouquet garni

METHOD

1. Cook veal trimmings until brown.
2. Sweat mirepoix.
3. Deglaze with white wine.
4. Add back veal trimmings, stock and Bouquet Garni, then reduce slowly.
5. Strain through fine cloth.
6. Infuse with basil and lavender briefly, then strain.
7. Strain and mount with butter.



PART IV

POMMES SOUFFLEES






INGREDIENTS

- 400 g potato
- 30 g potato starch
- 40 g egg white
- 300 g oil
- 5 g clarified butter

METHOD

1. Mandoline potatoes 1mm, and pat dry.
2. Brush one disc with egg white, and another with potato starch, enclose the two, brush outer layer with clarified butter, then chill.
3. Deep fry at 140°C until puffed up and light golden brown, then fry at 190°C briefly.
4. Season.



PART V

ROMESCO



INGREDIENTS

- 2 red bell pepper
- 300 g tomatoes
- 50 g garlic
- 10 g white wine vinegar
- 60 g almonds
- 5 g bread
- 5 g espelette
- 10 g Olive oil



METHOD

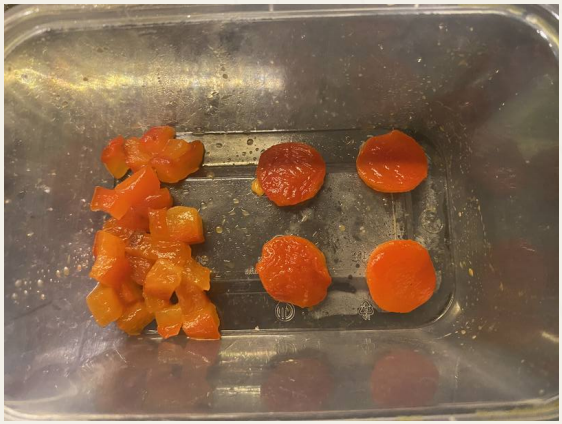
1. Roast pepper, tomato, and garlic at 230°C.
2. Take garlic out after 15 minutes, roast pepper for 30 minutes (turn halfway).
3. Toast almonds.
4. Peel garlic and bell peppers.
5. Blend Ingredients.
6. Pass through chinois.
7. Garnish with toasted almonds and pickled bell pepper.

PART VI

PICKLED BELL PEPPERS

INGREDIENTS

- 1 pc bell pepper
- 30 g shallot
- 100 g water
- 100 g white wine vinegar
- 1 garlic clove
- 1 g each of Thyme, Rosemary, Bay leaf



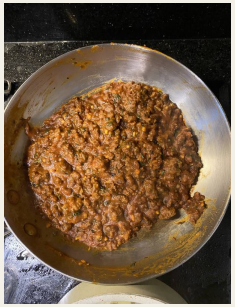
METHOD

1. Make pickling solution; boil water, white wine vinegar, salt, then cool down.
2. Roast 230°C shallots (15 minutes) and bell pepper (30 minutes).
3. Assemble into jar; sliced bell peppers, whole shallots, sliced garlic, pickling solution, herbs.



PART VII

STUFFED MUSHROOM




INGREDIENTS

- 50 g Onion
- 40 g Shallot
- 200 g Minced Veal Trimmings
- 400 g Tomato
- 20 g Tomato Paste
- 10 g Garlic
- 1 g each of Parsley, Rosemary, Thyme, Basil, Tarragon, chopped.
- 50 g Veal Stock
- 10 g Olive Oil

METHOD

1. For the stuffing (Bolognese), brown mince meat, strain.
2. Sweat and caramelize onion, then sweat minced garlic
3. Monder tomato, (collect juice), chop, cook with onion, blend, pass.
4. Add veal mince.
5. Add tomato sauce, and tomato paste.
6. Add veal stock, simmer, cover with cartouche.
7. Add herbs.
8. Add tomato juice, warm.
9. Scoop and hollow out base of mushroom, then braise with veal jus.
10. Assemble mushroom and bolognese.

PART VIII

BASIL CRISP





INGREDIENTS

- 1 g Basil
- 1 g Olive Oil

METHOD

1. Cover plate with cling film
2. Dip picked basil leaves to olive oil, then lay onto the plate
3. Microwave on high for 4 minutes or until crisp.



COST (IN THAI BAHT)

Salmon Mosaic

Compulsory	349
Others	-
Condiments	24
Vegetables	164
Dried Goods	12
Spices	-
Gelifiant & Binders	3
Flours & Starches	-
Nuts	21
Fat	6
Stocks	**-**
Alcohols	**-**
Herbs	13
Flowers	1
Dairy Products	18
Total Price	**611**
Price per Portion	**306**

Veal Provencale

Compulsory	1056
Others	1
Condiments	44
Vegetables	353
Dried Goods	2
Spices	5
Gelifiant & Binders	-
Flours & Starches	1
Nuts	20
Fat	89
Stocks	156
Alcohols	30
Herbs	7
Flowers	-
Dairy Products	30
Total Price	**1794**
Price per Portion	**897**









